

EDUCATION

Cornell University, Ithaca, NY	2021–Present
Ph.D. in Applied Economics & Management	
M.Sc. in Applied Economics & Management	
University of California, Davis, CA	2018
M.Sc. in Agricultural & Resource Economics	
Tehran University of Economic Sciences, Tehran	2014
M.Sc. in Finance, <i>Magna cum laude</i>	
B.Sc. in Finance, <i>Magna cum laude</i>	

PUBLICATIONS

Farnaz Safari. “*Stable Portfolios, Costly Churn: A High-Frequency View of Diversification and Transition in Rural Malawi.*” *Food Policy*, 2026.

WORKING PAPERS

Farnaz Safari. “*Economic Participation in Stratified Labor Markets*” (JMP)

Farnaz Safari and Joanna B. Upton. “*Occupational Mobility and the Price of Persistence*”

Dana J. Smith, Joanna B. Upton, and Farnaz Safari. “*Shifting Winds: Shocks and the Self-Selection of Migrants in Malawi*”

PRESENTATIONS

North East Universities Development Consortium (NEUDC)	2026 (scheduled)
<i>Occupational Mobility and the Price of Persistence</i>	
Better Data for Better Jobs and Lives: Innovations in Survey Measurement in the Age of AI	December 2025
<i>Bias from Aggregation? Rethinking Occupational Transitions & Diversification.</i>	
	World Bank Group, Washington, DC
German Development Economics Conference	Jun 2025
<i>Bias from Aggregation? Rethinking Occupational Transitions & Diversification.</i>	
	Goethe University, Germany
Collaboration for International Development Economics Research	Apr 2025
<i>Occupational Decisions Under Time-Varying Choice Sets: Role of Financial & Labor Market Frictions</i>	
	Cornell University
Collaboration for International Development Economics Research	Apr 2024
<i>Bias from Aggregation? Rethinking Occupational Transitions & Diversification.</i>	
	Cornell University

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Cornell University	2020 – 2021
Research Assistant to Dr. Joanna Upton	
Cornell University	2019 – 2020
Research Assistant to Prof. Jennifer Ifft	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Cornell University	Spring 2025
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Arnab Basu	
<i>Course: International Trade and Finance (Undergraduate)</i>	
Cornell University	Spring 2024
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Brian Dillon	
<i>Course: Economics of Developing Countries (Graduate and Undergraduate)</i>	
Cornell University	Fall 2023/2024/2025
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Prabhu Pingali	
<i>Course: Towards Sustainable Food Systems (Graduate and Undergraduate)</i>	
UC Davis	Spring 2018
Teaching Assistant	
<i>Course: Fundamentals of Organization Management</i>	
UC Davis	Winter 2017
Teaching Assistant to Prof. Jeffrey Williams	
<i>Course: Managerial Economics</i>	
UC Davis	Fall 2017
Teaching Assistant to John Constantin	
<i>Course: Investment</i>	

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE IN A PREVIOUS LIFE

National Investment Company (NICI)	2010 – 2014
Investment Analyst	

FELLOWSHIPS

Cornell University	2022 –2023
<i>Graduate School Fellow</i>	
Cornell University	2021 –2022
<i>Graduate School Fellow</i>	
UC Davis	2017 –2018
<i>Graduate School Fellow</i>	
Tehran University of Economic Sciences	2012
<i>Merit Fellowship</i>	

GRANTS

Tata-Cornell Institute, Main Study Grant (\$40,000)	2026
Advisor Research Funds, RCT Design Course at Nova School of Business & Economics (\$850)	2026
The Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics, Main Study Grant (\$49,560)	2025
The Weiss Fund for Research in Development Economics, Pilot Grant (\$7,380)	2025
Graduate School Research Travel Grant (\$2,000)	2025
Graduate School Conference Grant (\$700)	2025

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Course on Randomized Controlled Trial (RCT) Design	Summer 2026
Nova School of Business & Economics	

OTHER WRITINGS

Research Memo: Tearfund Malawi Drought Insurance 2025
“Power Analysis and Evaluation Design Recommendations”

M.Sc. Thesis, AEM, Ithaca 2022
“Financial Engagement & Seasonal Food Security: Evidence from Malawi.”

Dyson School of Applied Economics and Management Extension Bulletin 2019
“Adapting Your Labor Strategies to New York’s Revised Farm Employment Laws”

M.Sc. Thesis, Finance, Tehran 2014
“A Multi-Period Portfolio Selection Optimization Model: Meta-Heuristic Algorithm Under Uncertainty”

SOFTWARE

R, Stata, Julia

REFERENCES

Christopher B. Barrett

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Charles H. Dyson School of Applied Economics and
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Johannes Haushofer

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Adam Harris

Assistant Professor
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Joanna B. Upton

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